

the occasion by working out for a towel scene written into the Rs 5-crore movie his friend is directing. From corporates in Hugo Boss suits to independent producers in Gucci T-shirts, there's a new buzz in town. It's the new economy of Bollywood and it's extra large.

Everyone's speaking a new language. Stars are called talent, movies are projects, selling films is de-risking and buying them is building intellectual property rights. Over the next 15 months, even the sceptics will start using the jargon as listed companies and private producers proceed to spend Rs 3,000 crore on making movies. Reliance alone has an intended fund of \$1 billion (Rs 4,000 crore), of which it has committed Rs 500 crore. Between them, Eros, United Television (UTV) and Indian Films, an affiliate of tv18, have raised \$45 million, \$70 million and \$110 million, respectively, from the Alternative Investment Market (AIM) in London, which will soon find their way to starry back pockets and busy studio floors.

Then there are companies that have gone public, 12 since 2000, which

STUDIOS

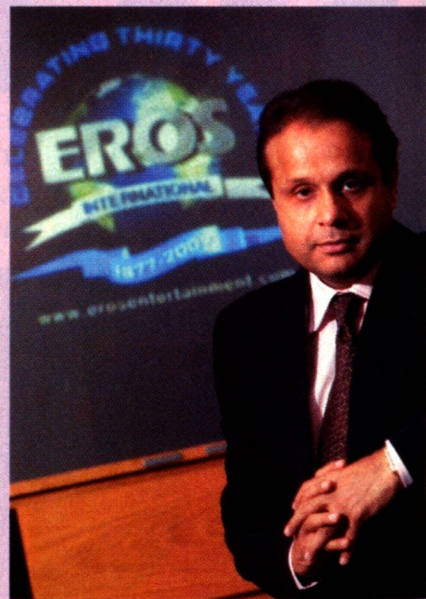
Cabin Fever

They speak a new language, buy movies before they're complete, sell them before they release. Meet the top guns of the bottom line.

You can almost smell the fresh paint in their spacious new offices. Some are new kids on the block, hoping their expertise in television production will rub off on the movies, such as Indian Films and UTV, which have both raised money on London's AIM. Others like the 31-year-old company Eros, being the first off the block to list on AIM in 2006, and being in control of 40 per cent of the growing overseas market, have a longer history, with a slate of 50 films over the next three years. All of them, as UTV's Ronnie Screwvala puts it, would like to build long-term relationships with key talent.

While Eros's Kishore Lulla can

boast of ties with a superstar like Shah Rukh Khan that date back to bringing him to London for the premiere of *Baazigar*, Screwvala can tick off the class directors on his roster, from Rakeysh Mehra to Vishal Bharadwaj. Newer players such as Pritish Nandy Communications (PNC) and PVR



BIG SPENDERS

WHO IS INVESTING HOW MUCH IN MOVIES OVER THE NEXT 15 MONTHS

Reliance Entertainment	Rs 500 cr	Shree Ashtavinayak	Rs 150 cr
Indian Films	Rs 440 cr	Dharma Productions	Rs 150 cr
YashRaj Films	Rs 350 cr	Mirchi Movies	Rs 120 cr
UTV	Rs 280 cr	PNC	Rs 100 cr
Eros	Rs 180 cr	PVR	Rs 100 cr



have raised another Rs 1,000-odd crore through their IPOs. The number of releases has gone up—the average number of what are known as high grade Hindi film releases has risen from 1.15 per week in 2001 to 1.71 in 2004—as has the number of prints. Everyone's earning more. Aamir Khan has just been paid Rs 20 crore plus a share of the overseas profits for the remake of the Tamil hit, *Ghajini*. Anees Bazmee, who charged Boney Kapoor Rs 1.5 crore just three years ago for writing and directing *No Entry*, is now asking for Rs 10 crore a film. Katrina Kaif who thought she got lucky when Vipul Shah paid her under Rs 1 crore for *Namastey London* has just signed a Rs 6-crore two-film deal with Indian Films. Priyanka Chopra has a two-film